

UNIT
82

A MATTER OF TASTE

CONVERSATION



Bruno: How's your pasta?

Laura: Not bad, but the sauce tastes as though it has too much garlic.

Bruno: Really? Mine tastes fine. The chicken is a little dry, though.

Laura: Yeah, it looks as if it was left in the oven too long.

Bruno: At least the seasoning is good.

Laura: True. And I like the texture of the pasta.

Bruno: Look at the dessert on the table next to us.

Laura: The one with the strawberries?

Bruno: Yeah. The fruit garnish looks really good.

Laura: It does. Maybe we should order one.



VOCABULARY



Aftertaste



Aroma



Consistency



Garnish



Seasoning



Ripeness



Texture



Tenderness



Bitterness



Acidity

As Though / As if + clause

How's the chicken?

It tastes **as though** it has been overcooked.



Sensory verbs

look

taste

smell

feel

sound

seem

Do you think this mango is ready to eat?

No. It looks **as if** it isn't ripe yet.





A MATTER OF TASTE

EXERCISE 1

Complete the second sentence using **as if** or **as though** and the words provided.

A. The chicken is extremely dry.

It tastes _____. (*overcook*)

B. This fruit is still very hard.

It feels _____. (*not / be / ripe*)

C. There is a strong burnt smell in the kitchen.

It smells _____. (*something / burn*)

D. The soup has almost no flavor.

It tastes _____. (*they / forget / the seasoning*)

E. The sauce is unusually thick.

It looks _____. (*it / cook / for too long*)

EXERCISE 2

Complete each comment with your own idea. Use **as if** or **as though**.

A. This meat is so tender. It feels

_____.

B. The coffee has a strange aftertaste. It tastes

_____.

C. The fruit has a very strong aroma. It smells

_____.

D. This sauce has a watery consistency. It looks

_____.

E. The vegetables are extremely bitter. They taste

_____.

SUMMARY

Structure	Use	Examples
look / taste / smell / feel / sound / seem + as if / as though + clause	Describes the impression something gives, rather than stating it as a confirmed fact.	The chicken tastes as though it has been overcooked. The mango feels as if it isn't ripe yet. It smells as though something has burned.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. as if/as though it has been overcooked
- B. as if/as though it isn't ripe
- C. as if/as though something has burned
- D. as if/as though they forgot the
seasoning
- E. as if/as though it has been cooked for
too long

Exercise 2

Answers vary.